



Missing in action: Seamer Mohammed Shami has not been included in India's squad for the England Tests as he recovers from an ankle injury. AP

management has shifted the focus towards developing fast bowlers. This strategic move has yielded remarkable results.

"In India, coming up as a fast bowler is very challenging. The Indian team and conditions are often hailed for their batting. For bowlers to be right up there and do that has been rare. But now, that bit has gone to the next level, and in different conditions. For us (the fast bowlers) to be able to do it well and that too, at home, is praiseworthy," Shami adds.

Although he had a memorable outing in the World Cup, he had to sit out for the first few games. But an injury to Hardik Pandya eventually

paved his way into the playing eleven. "The year was good because of the hard work we put in, and all the preparation we put in ahead of the World Cup was really good. Before that, the IPL also went well, so I was confident. I was enjoying myself through my performances because the platform was set," he said. "The set-up was good, and the

output was good. Only one thing was missing from our 2023 campaign (the title), and I hope we can get that in 2024."

With four months to go until yet another ICC event, getting into shape remains Shami's target. He wants to quickly get into the groove and be himself — on and off the pitch.



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